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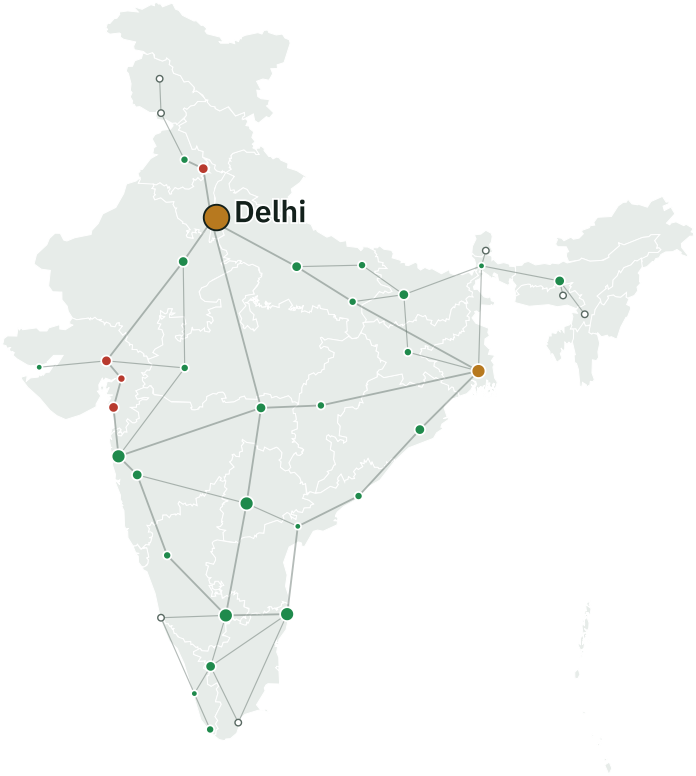
Late stock pays air freight about 80% above last year

● NETWORK: AMBER

DIWALI WEEK · 1 DAY SINCE DIWALI

For heads of logistics moving goods within, into or out of India, wherever they sit: what to move, hold or reroute this week.

The TAC Index puts air rates from India around 80% above last year[1], so the export load that missed its sailing is the expensive one this week. At home, forecasters say Delhi's air could turn severe from today, which would keep its truck curbs going. Most Gujarat firms shut from Tuesday, and Kolkata's immersions keep goods vehicles off its roads till Wednesday.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for the week: busy, but plans hold
● AMBER something slows freight beyond a normal week
● RED freight largely stopped across a state, corridor or gateway

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Sun 1 Nov** Delhi turns away BS-IV and older vehicles at its borders[2]
- **Mon 9 – Wed 11 Nov** Kolkata curbs goods vehicles for the immersions
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Most Gujarat firms shut till Labh Pancham

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
AMBER	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely extra days on freight within the region this week, to Sun 15 Nov, on the places named, against a normal week.

Beyond the dates above, I found no report this morning of a road, railway or border slowing freight in the South, East, Central India or the Northeast.

With Gulf hubs running short, India's air exports are paying for longer routes

North, West · Air exports to Europe and the US, through Delhi, Mumbai and India's other cargo airports

GREEN · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Rates from India firmed slightly to both Europe and the US in the week to 2 November, the TAC Index shows[1]. Much of India's export cargo used to go through Gulf hubs, which Kuehne+Nagel's air chief puts at 80 to 90% of pre-conflict throughput, and Lufthansa Cargo says it added freighters, particularly from India[3]. Mind you, both figures come through one trade paper, and I found no report of a backlog at any Indian airport.

- **Delhi airport, for Europe and the US** North · +0 days Delhi moved 71,765 tonnes of international air freight in August[4]. Rates firmed rather than spiked, so I'd expect loads to leave on time this week at the higher price.
- **Mumbai airport, for pharma and urgent cargo** West · +0 days Mumbai moved 64,565 tonnes in the same month[4]. Pharma and time-critical cargo are keeping demand from India strong[3], so I'd expect those loads to pay most for a late booking this week.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For freight into and out of India

- Keep air for pharma and stock that truly cannot wait; a load that can still make a sailing is likely to cost far less on the water, my estimate.
- Ask your forwarder which routing a Europe or US load takes before you promise a date; a longer routing can add days even when the booking holds, my estimate.

Delhi's air may turn severe, so its truck curbs look set to last the week

North · Delhi and the NCR towns around it, as loads restart after Diwali

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Monday's 5 am air reading was 366[5]. The early-warning system says Delhi could enter the severe category from today and stay there a few days[5], so I'd expect the truck curbs to hold through this week's restart. The ITO station had already touched 406 before dawn, and Stage III of Delhi's pollution plan remains in force[6]. I found no end date from CAQM, the air-quality regulator.

- **Delhi-NCR** North · +1 day The week after Diwali is when held loads restart, and fewer trucks qualify for the city. I'd expect deliveries into Delhi to run a day behind until the index falls, probably into next week.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For freight within India

- Plan Delhi loads this week on the assumption that Stage III does not lift; a truck that fails the rule at the border costs you the day, my estimate.

SOURCES

1. STAT Times: Global air freight rates ease 1.1% as peak season demand remains strong (TAC Index), 4 Nov
2. ETV Bharat: Delhi turns away BS-IV vehicles for a second day, 2 Nov
3. STAT Times: Peak season, disrupted skies and a Central Asian long shot, 7 Nov
4. Airports Authority of India: air freight by airport, August 2026 annex, read 9 Nov
5. NewsDrum: Delhi-NCR AQI today, air turns severe in several areas, 9 Nov
6. The News Mill: Delhi's air quality reaches severe on Diwali with AQI 406, 9 Nov